

ENVIRONMENTAL SCIENCES AND RENEWABLE
ENERGY
(ME306)

ASSIGNMENT

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The United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) was created in the wake of growing global concern about the environment after the 1972 UN Conference on the Human Environment (Stockholm Conference). The UN General Assembly formally established UNEP by resolution (2997 (XXVII)) to serve as the UN's central environmental voice — to coordinate environmental activities across the UN system, advise and assist governments, and stimulate international cooperation on environmental issues. UNEP's headquarters were later established in Nairobi, Kenya.

➤ **Purpose of establishment of United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)**

UNEP was established in **1972** after the Stockholm Conference on the Human Environment. Its establishment had clear and specific purposes focused on protecting the global environment and guiding countries toward sustainable development.

Main purposes of establishment:

1. To provide global environmental leadership

UNEP was created to act as the leading authority within the United Nations system on environmental matters. It guides international efforts to protect the environment and promotes cooperation among nations.

2. To coordinate environmental activities within the UN system

Before UNEP, environmental work was scattered across different UN agencies. UNEP was established to coordinate these efforts so that environmental policies and programs are consistent and effective worldwide.

3. To address global environmental problems collectively

Issues such as climate change, pollution, deforestation, biodiversity loss, and land degradation cross national borders. UNEP was formed to help countries work together to solve these shared environmental challenges.

4. To promote sustainable development

UNEP aims to balance environmental protection with economic and social

development, ensuring that development today does not harm future generations.

5. To support governments with scientific knowledge and policy advice

UNEP provides scientific assessments, research, and data to help governments make informed environmental policies and decisions.

6. To assist developing countries

A major purpose of UNEP's establishment was to support developing nations through technical assistance, capacity building, and funding support so they can protect their environment while pursuing development.

7. To raise global environmental awareness

UNEP was established to educate people, governments, and organizations about environmental issues and encourage public participation in environmental protection (e.g., World Environment Day).

➤ **Functions of United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)**

1. Environmental leadership:

Provides leadership and sets the global environmental agenda within the United Nations system.

2. Policy guidance and coordination:

Coordinates environmental activities of UN agencies and advises governments on environmental policies.

3. Scientific assessment and reporting:

Collects, analyzes, and publishes scientific data and reports on global environmental conditions.

4. Technical assistance and capacity building:

Supports countries, especially developing nations, with training, technology, and environmental projects.

5. International cooperation and agreements:

Promotes and supports international environmental treaties and cooperation among member countries.

➤ Member Countries of United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)

UNEP has **universal membership**, meaning all **193 member countries of the United Nations** are members of UNEP. Every country has the right to participate and vote in the **United Nations Environment Assembly (UNEA)**, which is UNEP's highest decision-making body. This ensures equal representation of developed, developing, and least-developed countries from all regions of the world. Many member states maintain permanent representatives in Nairobi, Kenya, where UNEP is headquartered, enabling continuous cooperation on global environmental issues.

➤ Purpose of establishment of United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)

1. **Global environmental leadership:**

To act as the leading authority on environmental issues within the United Nations.

2. **Environmental protection:**

To protect the Earth from pollution, environmental degradation, and resource depletion.

3. **International cooperation:**

To encourage cooperation among nations to address global environmental challenges.

4. **Sustainable development:**

To promote development that meets present needs without harming future generations.

5. **Scientific support and research:**

To provide scientific assessments and environmental data for informed decision-making.

6. **Assistance to developing countries:**

To support developing nations through technical assistance, training, and capacity building.

➤ Recent Conferences and Events (2024–2025)

1. Sixth Session of the United Nations Environment Assembly (UNEA-6)

- Held from **26 February to 1 March 2024** at UNEP headquarters in Nairobi, Kenya.
- Theme: *Effective, inclusive and sustainable multilateral actions to tackle climate change, biodiversity loss and pollution.*
- UNEA is the highest decision-making body on the environment for all UN member states.

2. World Environment Day 2024

- Celebrated on **5 June 2024** with the theme focusing on **land restoration, desertification and drought resilience.**
- Hosted by the **Kingdom of Saudi Arabia**, this global campaign mobilised countries and communities to restore ecosystems.

3. Intergovernmental Negotiating Committee on Plastic Pollution (INC-5.1 & INC-5.2)

- **INC-5.1:** Held **25 November – 1 December 2024** in Busan, Republic of Korea.
- **INC-5.2:** Continued from **5–14 August 2025** in Geneva, Switzerland.
- These meetings advanced negotiations toward a **global legally binding treaty on plastic pollution.**

4. World Environment Day 2025

- Observed on **5 June 2025**, with **Republic of Korea** as the global host.
- Theme: **#BeatPlasticPollution** — focused on collective global action to combat plastic waste.

5. Sixth Forum of Ministers and Environment Authorities of Asia-Pacific (6th AP Forum)

- Took place **26–29 August 2025** in **Nadi, Fiji**, jointly organized with UNEP.
- Ministers and senior officials from Asia-Pacific discussed regional environmental priorities and policy collaboration.

6. Regional Roundtable on Sustainable Finance (UNEP FI — Europe)

- Organized on **28–29 October 2025** in **Brussels, Belgium** by the UNEP Finance Initiative.
- Focused on sustainable finance and transition to a greener economy in Europe.

7. Seventh Session of the United Nations Environment Assembly (UNEA-7)

- Held from **8–12 December 2025** at UNEP headquarters in Nairobi, Kenya.
- Theme: *Advancing sustainable solutions for a resilient planet.*
- The session brought together all UN member states to set global environmental priorities and adopt new resolutions.

➤ Resources / References

1. Official Website of United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) – www.unep.org
2. Wikipedia – United Nations Environment Programme
3. ChatGPT (for summarization and explanation)